





rural connectivity, following the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana model. Phase 2 includes 30,000 km, with 7,000 km approved in February 2024 and 23,000 km in March 2024. Roads will use Thin White Topping (TWT) technology for durability.

Integrated Rural Development Approach: New Steps and Success Stories

The Rural Development Department, under Minister Girish Mahajan, has implemented an integrated development strategy in Maharashtra, focusing on various rural aspects. This includes expanding infrastructure, empowering women's savings groups, and providing local training for youth. The approach aims to ensure comprehensive progress by addressing all related sectors simultaneously.

Development of Projects Suggested by Public Representatives: ₹7,184 Crore of Initiatives

In Maharashtra, works suggested by public representatives have been executed, creating a network of basic facilities in rural areas from 2022 to 2024. Projects worth ₹7,184 crore were approved, covering roads, drainage, protective walls, tree planting, and more. The program includes 1,988 approved Gram Panchayat buildings, 1,255 crematoriums, 200 Zilla Parishad schools, 66 libraries, and 523 gyms.

Training in the Panchayat Raj System: Government's Steps Towards Good Governance

The Panchayat Raj system in Maharashtra, comprising Gram Panchayats, Panchayat Samitis, and Zilla Parishads, trained 2.1 million representatives and employees over two years. The training aimed to enhance governance and included 693,518 representatives. Maharashtra leads in training under the National Gram Swaraj Abhiyan, creating 15,951 trainers. The state also developed a roadmap for localizing Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Accelerated Construction of Gram Panchayat Offices: ₹229 Crore Fund Allocation

Maharashtra is accelerating the construction of Gram Panchayat offices, with funds allocated for 2022-2024. The government approved 1,988 buildings, including 1,260 under the Balasaheb Thackeray Smriti Matoshri Gram Panchayat Construction Scheme. Previously, Gram Panchayats had to contribute 10% of the cost, but this requirement has been removed, with the state covering 100%. In 2023-24, the government allocated ₹229 crore, with an additional ₹37 crore approved for 178 buildings in June 2024.

Development of Pilgrimage Sites: Modernizing Ancient Traditions

Maharashtra's Rural Development Department is enhancing pilgrimage sites by providing various facilities. Inspired by Punia Ahilyadevi Holkar, who built temples and developed pilgrimage sites, the



